



**JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE**  
Policy on the Management of Electronic Mail

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## 1.0 Introduction

An essential strategic priority of the JCF is the promise of effective internal and external communication. External communication facilitates the engagement of the organization's key stakeholders, primarily the citizens of Jamaica. One of the strategies employed to achieve this objective is the sharing of the Weekly Force Orders.

While the organization seeks to improve external communication, it must simultaneously improve the way in which communications are made within. The past few years have witnessed revolutionary changes in the use of information and communication technology within the JCF. In particular, electronic mail (email) has become a vital component of the total job function of the average member.

The use of email within the JCF must however be managed and guided by policy in order to achieve a common standard of quality that can enhance the members' productivity and organizational success. Against this background, this policy seeks to present a framework for the management of emails in the organization.

## 2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to provide policy directives governing the use of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF) official Email. This document amends section D.5E-Mail in the Information and Communication Technology Policy for the JCF. More specifically it:

- 2.1 sets standards to ensure professional uses of the JCF Email;
- 2.2 outlines the requirements for use of the JCF email; and
- 2.4 allows for JCF's email to become an official means of communication.

## 3.0 Scope

This policy applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the JCF, and includes contractors and consultants who are assigned JCF Email accounts. It covers the appropriate use of the JCF Email as an official means of communicating.

## 4.0 Abbreviations

|      |                                                   |
|------|---------------------------------------------------|
| ICTD | Information Communication and Technology Division |
| JCF  | Jamaica Constabulary Force                        |

## 5.0 Definition

- 5.1 **JCF E-Mail** Refers to any email account with the domain being **jcf.gov.jm**  
It covers any and all email messages including attachments sent using this email account
- 5.2 **Defamatory** False statement or series of statements which affect the reputation of a person or an organisation.

## **6.0 Roles and Responsibilities**

- 6.1 ACP Technology Branch** is responsible for the creation, administration and security of the JCF E-mail systems and user accounts.
- 6.2 Members** shall be responsible to observe this policy and SOP for the effective and professional handling and use of the JCF E-mail.
- 6.3 Officers and sub-officers** are responsible to ensure that:
  - 6.3.1** members under their command/supervision are made aware of the provisions of this policy and are able to deal professionally with issues relating to it
  - 6.3.2** members who fail to comply with this policy are held accountable and dealt with in accordance with JCF disciplinary process.

## **7.0 Policy Statements**

It is the policy of the JCF that:

- 7.1** All members of the JCF and its auxiliary shall be issued with JCF Email accounts
- 7.2** Executive command directives and communiqués to the members that are sent by email will be considered read:-
  - i. two (2) days after it is sent; or
  - ii. upon acknowledgement by the recipient
- 7.2** All members of the Officer Corp are required to check their E-mails at least twice per day;
- 7.3** All other members shall check their emails at least once per day; and
- 7.4** Members are allowed to use their personal computers, and smart phone devices to access their JCF email accounts.
- 7.5 Official Use**

The JCF Email shall be used to treat with official matters (such as outlined in **Appendix 1**) and include:

  - 7.5.1** matters of law enforcement and national security
  - 7.5.2** communication by members operating in their official capacity
- 7.6 Personal Use**
  - 7.6.1** Members shall not utilize their personal Email to conduct official work except where special provision is made.

## **7.7 Prohibited Use**

The JCF Email system shall not be used for:

7.7.1 The creation and distribution of any offensive messages, images, and videos including offensive comments that might be construed to be fraudulent, defamatory, racist, homophobic, political and irreligious.

7.7.2 Targeting any minority group to include persons living with disabilities, suffering from any disease etc

## **7.8 Access to JCF Email**

All members of the JCF are required to have a JCF Email account. Members without E-mail access shall:

8.4.1 Inform their immediate supervisor

8.4.2 Contact ICTD helpdesk

## **7.9 Maintenance**

The capacity of the email is 10 Gigabytes. Therefore, it is the responsibility of each member to ensure that the respective inbox is cleared prior to it reaching the capacity. If this is not done then emails that are sent afterwards will not be delivered, and even so, such emails would have been deemed 'sent' and 'received' by the sender.

## **7.10 Monitoring**

The JCF reserves the right to:

8.7.1 monitor all emails without prior notification;

8.7.2 retrieve the contents of all incoming and outgoing messages; and

8.7.2 to assist in the investigations of wrongful acts or to comply with any legal obligation.

## **7.11 Enforcement**

Any member who violates this policy may be subject to disciplinary action or criminal actions as appropriate.

# **8.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles**

This Policy shall be read in conjunction with the following:

8.1 JCF Corporate use of Social Media Policy

8.2 JCF Personal Use of Social Media Policy

## **Appendix 1: Email Communication**

**Some of the communiqués that will be sent via email includes:**

- a. Force Orders
- b. Issuing of Force directives
- c. Examination syllabi
- d. Administrative correspondences
- e. Work schedules (All changes should be sent at least six (6) hours before start of duty)
- f. Notices and Reminders about Court Attendance and related duties
- g. Alerts and Bulletins for frontline officers
- h. Staff Commendations
- i. Officer Safety Reminders
- j. Citizen Security Reminders

### **Communication Hubs:**

- a. ICTD - All HQ communications and All Staff messages
- b. Portfolios - All communications ongoing to that level
- c. Branches and Areas - All communications ongoing at that level
- d. Divisions - All communications ongoing from that level and confined to
- e. Divisional staff.